Social Media Marketing

Social Media Auditing and Competitor Research

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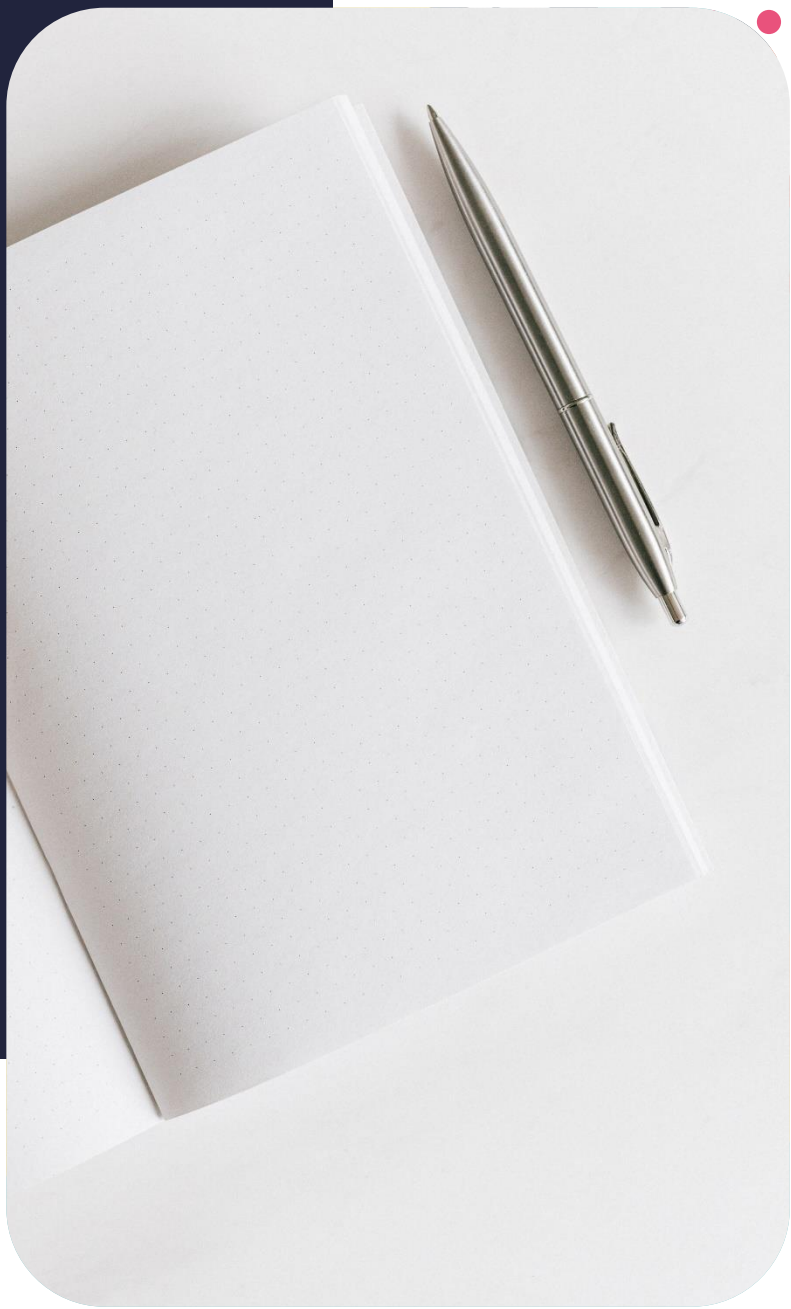

Lesson outcomes

- Why auditing is important
- How to conduct a social media audit
- Check that your profiles are optimised
- Analysing your social media posts
- Competitor research

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW: Up to 80% of your results come from 20% of your efforts. This is referred to as the 80/20 principle or the pareto principle. This rule applies to all social media when using it for business purposes. This means that 80% of your outcomes come from 20% of your inputs, this ratio has also been applied to many other situations, including sales, which states that 80% of your sales come from 20% of your clients.

What is a social media audit?

A social media audit is a set of steps taken to evaluate and optimise a business' social media profiles and strategies.

The importance of a social media audit

Auditing allows you to;

- Identify strengths and weaknesses so that you can identify and eliminate any activities or
- actions that do not contribute meaningfully to your business and take advantage of the
- activities or actions that do contribute positively.
- Take advantage of possible opportunities that you are currently not taking advantage of.
- Check that your brand is being accurately represented online. It's important to ensure
- that your social media profiles are on brand, representing your brand correctly and
- driving the right messages home to achieve your goals as well as identifying and
- eliminating inactive accounts.
- Check cross-functional awareness of goals and results. It's important to use the right
- channels and that your channels and content are aligned with the goals that you want to
- achieve. You need to identify what is helping you and what is hindering you in your
- social media marketing.

ACCESS YOUR TEMPLATE

Social Media Audit Template

The importance of a social media audit

Step 1: Identify social media channels

Primary Channels

- List the channel
- Profile URL
- Profile handle

Secondary Channels

- List the channel
- Delete or optimise
- Set a deadline

You can check the value of your channel on Google Analytics > Acquisition > Social > Conversions

Step 2: Fill in the relevant data

Align the metrics for each platform with your goals.

- Followers
- Platform metrics

Step 3: Identify target demographics for each channel

- Use buyer personas linked to each channel
- Check user demographics with online research
- Check data on social media channels

Step 4: Individual post analysis

- Add individual social media tabs to excel sheet
- Identify top posts per platform
- List relevant metrics and data for posts

Remember that each platform will have different post metrics and these should also be aligned with your goals.

Step 5: SWOT and Stop, Start, Continue

Identify your strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats

Strengths

- What are you doing well?
- What differentiates you from your competitor?
- What internal resources can you leverage as a strength?

Weaknesses

- What does your company lack?
- What are your resource limitations?
- What do your competitors do well?

Opportunities

- Underserved markets
- Cross-selling opportunities
- New products or services
- Co-branding opportunities

Threats

- Emerging competitors
- Changing regulatory environment
- Negative brand sentiment
- Changing customer attitudes

Apply the stop, start and continue method

- Stop: what do you want to stop as it may be ineffective
- Start: what do you want to start doing on social media if it seems promising
- Continue: what do you want to continue doing that is effective

Step 6: Competitive Analysis

1. Identify 3 Competitors
2. Check their website
   a) Analyse their user experience
   b) Ease of use
   c) Ability to understand content
   d) Purchase process
   e) Emotional responses
3. Check their social media channels
   a) Do they have a consistent brand presence
   b) Are their pages verified?
   c) Do they have consistent use of visuals
   d) Do they provide the information their audience wants?
   e) How are their pages performing?
4. Check their app
   a) Ratings
   b) Reviews
   c) Number of downloads
5. Continuously watch competitors
   a) Facebook Pages to Watch feature
   b) Twitter Lists
   c) LinkedIn Companies to track
6. Add competitor analysis to audit
   a) Competitor name

b) Social platform
c) Link to profile
d) Followers
e) Additional metrics
f) SWOT

7. Competitor SWOT
   a) Strengths: What does your competitor do well? What differentiates them from
   b) you?
   c) Weaknesses: What do they lack? What are they not doing well?
   d) Opportunities: Underserved markets, cross-selling opportunities, new products or
   e) services, co-branding opportunities
   f) Threats: What is your competitor doing better than you?

Step 7: Check optimisation of your platforms

Optimise your strategy

- Do your social media goals solve challenges?
- Do your social media efforts extend through your entire organisation?
- Does it focus on social media platforms that add value?
- Is your content engaging?
- Are you able to identify any other business opportunities?
- Are you engaging with your audience?
- Are you tracking, measuring and improving your marketing efforts?

Check your keywords

- Look at your keyword list
- Conduct research on those keywords - are they still relevant?
- Are there any new keywords to include?
- Start using new keywords or add additional keywords
- Check keywords are in use for new products or services

Optimise your content

- Conduct A/B split testing: this is testing various elements of the same post or page.
- Maybe you have a post and each post has the same image and colour scheme, but it has a different headline – or maybe it has the same headline but uses different images - when AB split testing ensure that you only change one element at a time so that you know what makes a bigger impact.
- Analyse the use of graphics: by now we know how important using a relevant image is in our social media - I have spoken about this in more than one lesson. Again, I want to highlight the importance of using images that appeal to your audience and that are relevant to the content that you are posting.
- Analyse your hashtag usage: research and use relevant hashtags according to what your post is about.
- Post length: Keep in mind who your user is - there is no point in posting long posts but your users are never going to read them.

Check posting schedule

Double check that your time - what time you post - and your posting frequency - how often you post - still appeals to your audience.

Step 8: Analyse your processes

Look at your internal content creation processes to see if they are efficient and how you can improve them. Ask yourself;

- Who creates and posts content?
- Is there a framework for the types of posts?
- How is our brand voice used during content creation?
- What is our response plan to both emergencies and questions - is this still relevant?
- How does communication differ on the various channels?

Auditing software and tools

- Socialbakers
- Klear
- Union metrics
- SumAll
- Followerwonk (Twitter only)
- Likealyzer (Facebook only)